

ALEXEI LEONOV

Born 1934

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: First human to carry out a spacewalk



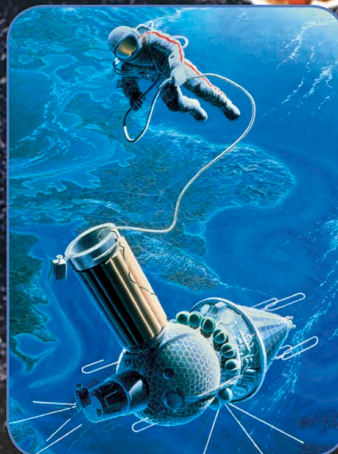
COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Russia



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1965

A skilled artist, **Leonov pencil-skipped** the views from space.

In 1965, Russian cosmonaut Alexei Leonov carried out the first-ever “spacewalk” or EVA (extravehicular activity). He was outside the spacecraft Voskhod 2 for 12 minutes and 9 seconds. In the vacuum of space his suit had inflated and he was unable to pass back into the airlock until he opened a valve to release the pressure.



Artist's impression of Leonov's first spacewalk